

Mains Master Program 2024: Art and Culture (GS1)

Handout 1

PYQs

11 Years, 27 Questions

- 2023
 - Explain the geographical factors towards the development of Ancient India.
 - What were the main features of Vedic society and religion? Do you think some of the features are still prevailing in Indian society?
 - What were the major technological changes introduced during the Sultanate period? How did these technological changes influence Indian society?
- 2022
 - How will you explain that medieval Indian temple sculptures represent the social life of those days.
 - Discuss the main contributions of Gupta period and Chola period to Indian heritage and culture.
 - Discuss the significance of lion and bull figures in Indian mythology, art and architecture.
- 2021
 - Evaluate the nature of the Bhakti Literature and its contribution to Indian culture.
- 2020
 - The rock-cut architecture represents one of the most important sources of our knowledge of early Indian art and history. Discuss.
 - Pala period is the most significant phase in the history of Buddhism in India. Enumerate.
 - Indian philosophy and tradition played a significant role in conceiving and shaping the monuments and their art in India. Discuss.
 - Persian literary sources of medieval India reflect the spirit of the age. Comment.
- 2019
 - Highlight the Central Asian and Greco -Bactrian elements in Gandhara art.
- 2018
 - Safeguarding the Indian art heritage is the need of the moment. Discuss.
 - Assess the importance of the accounts of the Chinese and Arab travellers in the reconstruction of the history of India.
 - The Bhakti movement received a remarkable re-orientation with the advent of Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu. Discuss.
- 2017
 - How do you justify the view that the level of excellence of Gupta numismatic art is not at all noticeable in later times?
- 2016
 - Early Buddhist Stupa-art, while depicting folk motifs and narratives successfully expounds Buddhist ideals. Elucidate.
 - Krishnadeva Raya, the King of Vijayanagar, was not only an accomplished scholar himself but was also a great patron of learning and literature. Discuss.
- 2015
 - The ancient civilization in Indian sub-continent differed from those of Egypt, Mesopotamia and Greece in that its culture and traditions have been preserved without a breakdown to the present day. Comment.

- Mesolithic rock-cut architecture of India not only reflects the cultural life of the times but also a fine aesthetic sense comparable to modern painting. Critically evaluate this comment.
- 2014
 - To what extent has the urban planning and culture of the Indus Valley Civilization provided inputs to the present-day urbanization? Discuss.
 - Gandhara sculpture owed as much to the Romans as to the Greeks. Explain.
 - Taxila university was one of the oldest universities of the world with which were associated a number of renowned learned personalities of different disciplines. Its strategic location caused its fame to flourish, but unlike Nalanda, it is not considered as a university in the modern sense. Discuss.
 - Sufis and medieval mystic saints failed to modify either the religious ideas and practices or the outward structure of Hindu / Muslim societies to any appreciable extent. Comment.
- 2013
 - Though not very useful from the point of view of a connected political history of South India, the Sangam literature portrays the social and economic conditions of its time with remarkable vividness. Comment.
 - Discuss the Tandava dance as recorded in the early Indian inscriptions.
 - Chola architecture represents a high watermark in the evolution of temple architecture. Discuss.

Question	Era	Typology
Explain the geographical factors towards the development of Ancient India.	Overall	Interpretative
What were the main features of Vedic society and religion? Do you think some of the features are still prevailing in Indian society?	Ancient	Descriptive + Interpretative
What were the major technological changes introduced during the Sultanate period? How did these technological changes influence Indian society?	Medieval	Interpretative
How will you explain that medieval Indian temple sculptures represent the social life of those days.	Medieval	Interpretative
Discuss the main contributions of Gupta period and Chola period to Indian heritage and culture.	Ancient + Medieval	Descriptive
Discuss the significance of lion and bull figures in Indian mythology, art and architecture.	Overall	Interpretative
Evaluate the nature of the Bhakti Literature and its contribution to Indian culture.	Overall	Interpretative
The rock-cut architecture represents one of the most important sources of our knowledge of early Indian art and history. Discuss.	Ancient	Interpretative
Pala period is the most significant phase in the history of Buddhism in India. Enumerate	Medieval	Descriptive
Indian philosophy and tradition played a significant role in conceiving and shaping the monuments and their art in India. Discuss.	Ancient	Interpretative
Persian literary sources of medieval India reflect the spirit of the age. Comment.	Medieval	Interpretative
Highlight the Central Asian and Greco-Bactrian elements in Gandhara art.	Ancient	Descriptive
Safeguarding the Indian art heritage is the need of the moment. Discuss.	Overall	Miscellaneous
Assess the importance of the accounts of the Chinese and Arab travellers in the reconstruction of the history of India.	Overall	Interpretative
The Bhakti movement received a remarkable re-orientation with the advent of Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu. Discuss.	Medieval	Descriptive
How do you justify the view that the level of excellence of Gupta numismatic art is not at all noticeable in later times?	Ancient	Interpretative
Early Buddhist Stupa-art, while depicting folk motifs and narratives successfully expounds Buddhist ideals. Elucidate.	Ancient	Interpretative
Krishnadeva Raya, the King of Vijayanagar, was not only an accomplished scholar himself but was also a great patron of learning and literature. Discuss.	Medieval	Descriptive
The ancient civilization in Indian sub-continent differed from those of Egypt, Mesopotamia and Greece in that its culture and traditions have been preserved without a breakdown to the present day. Comment.	Overall	Interpretative
Mesolithic rock cut architecture of India not only reflects the cultural life of the times but also a fine aesthetic sense comparable to modern painting. Critically evaluate this comment.	Ancient	Interpretative
To what extent has the urban planning and culture of the Indus Valley Civilization provided inputs to the present-day urbanization? Discuss.	Ancient	Interpretative

Gandhara sculpture owed as much to the Romans as to the Greeks. Explain.	Ancient	Descriptive
Taxila university was one of the oldest universities of the world with which were associated a number of renowned learned personalities of different disciplines. Its strategic location caused its fame to flourish, but unlike Nalanda, it is not considered as a university in the modern sense. Discuss.	Ancient	Interpretative
Sufis and medieval mystic saints failed to modify either the religious ideas and practices or the outward structure of Hindu / Muslim societies to any appreciable extent. Comment.	Medieval	Interpretative
Though not very useful from the point of view of a connected political history of South India, the Sangam literature portrays the social and economic conditions of its time with remarkable vividness. Comment.	Ancient	Interpretative
Discuss the Tandava dance as recorded in the early Indian inscriptions.	Ancient	Descriptive
Chola architecture represents a high watermark in the evolution of temple architecture. Discuss.	Medieval	Descriptive